Day 67 - Colpoy's Bluff, Whicher, Mallory Beach, Crawford Drive, Gatis

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 88 · Colpoy's Bay Bluff

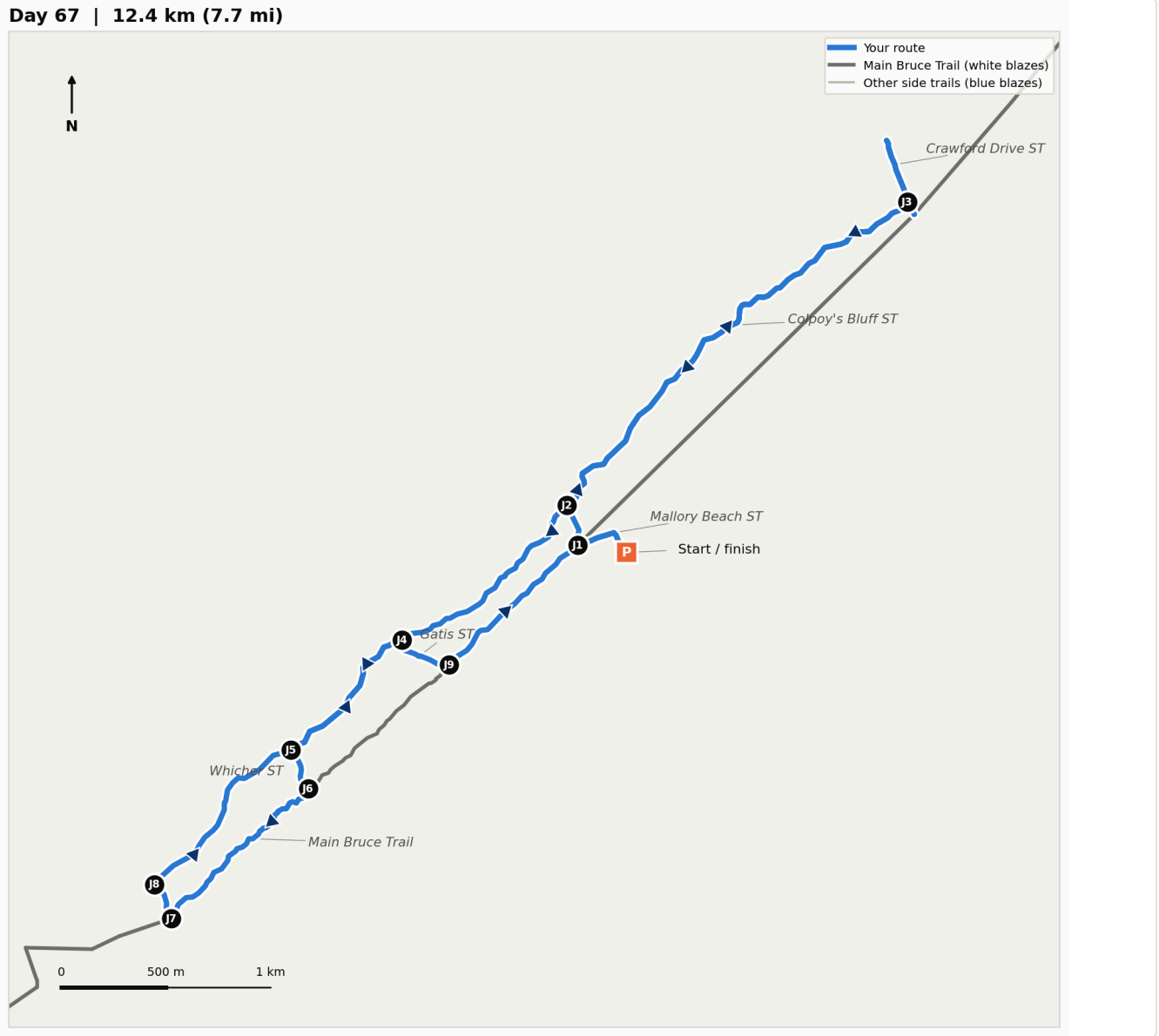
12.4 km / 7.7 mi	~4.5 h	6.8 km new	187 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Limited parking on the north side of the road, providing access to the Mallory Beach Side Trail. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day67_hike088.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail (4.3 km); Whicher Side Trail (1.4 km); Mallory Beach Side Trail (0.5 km); Crawford Drive Side Trail (0.4 km); Gatis Side Trail (0.3 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Limited parking on the north side of the road at the Mallory Beach Side Trail. Arrive early.
- **Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail:** The longest stretch of the day. Ontario Nature Trails describes about 4 km of blue blazes between the Crawford Dr Side Trail and the Whicher Side Trail. We found no description of its footing.
- **Whicher Side Trail and the disappearing stream:** A short spur off the Whicher Side Trail leads to a disappearing stream, which a Hike Bike Travel writer counted among the trail's "gems".
- **Main Bruce Trail along Colpoy's Bay Bluff:** A 2015 trip report describes mature forest along the escarpment edge with little elevation change and firm, sometimes rocky footing. It mentions occasional spectacular lookouts over Colpoy's Bay. Sharon's Bench, a memorial to Bruce Trail hiker Sharon France, sits near the Mallory Beach Side Trail.

- **Cliff edge:** The same report notes large dolostone blocks along the edge that looked ready to fall. Stay back from the lip at lookouts and keep Zappy close on a short leash.
- **Distance:** At 12.6 km, this is a full day. Bring enough water for both of you, since the route has no amenities.
- **Gatis and Mallory Beach Side Trails:** Short blue-blazed connectors. Ontario Nature Trails uses them as shortcuts in the Colpoy's Bluff loop, but it doesn't describe them. We found no details on their footing.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Limited parking on the north side of the road, providing access to the Mallory Beach Side.... Walk about 40 m to the trail. Head north on the blue-blazed Mallory Beach Side Trail. The next 0.3 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
0.3	0.2	J1: Junction. Turn right to stay on the Mallory Beach Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
0.5	0.3	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail goes off on your left.)
2.8	1.8	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Crawford Drive Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Crawford Drive Side Trail goes off on your left.) This is a short excursion (about 760 m in all): walk the whole Crawford Drive Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction. The next 0.8 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
3.6	2.2	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail, heading south-west. (the Crawford Drive Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
5.9	3.7	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail, heading south-west. (the Mallory Beach Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
7.0	4.4	J4: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Gatis Side Trail goes off on your left.)
7.8	4.9	J5: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Whicher Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Whicher Side Trail goes off ahead.)
8.1	5.0	J6: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
9.0	5.6	J7: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Whicher Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
9.2	5.7	J8: Junction. Turn right to stay on the Whicher Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Whicher Side Trail (disappearing stream) goes off ahead.)
10.2	6.3	J5: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail, heading north-east. (the Whicher Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
11.0	6.8	J4: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Gatis Side Trail, heading south. (the Colpoy's Bluff Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
11.3	7.0	J9: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
12.1	7.5	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Mallory Beach Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead; the Mallory Beach Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.) The next 0.3 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
12.4	7.7	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails, Hike Bike Travel and the Vanderplas family's Bruce Trail journal.